



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Erica Gorenberg

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Mon, Dec 9, 2019 at 12:19 PM

Reply-To: egorenberg@gmail.com

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Erica Gorenberg

Gender

Female

Email

egorenberg@gmail.com

When did or will you finish your PhD?

May 2020

Your city, state, and country of residence

Bridgeport, CT, USA

Your university education

PhD | Neuroscience | Yale University, New Haven, CT | August 2015 - Expected May, 2020
MPhil | Neuroscience | Yale University, New Haven, CT | August 2015 - May, 2018
BS | Biology | Ursinus College, Collegeville, PA | August 2011 - May 2015

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

The ability to apply knowledge to a novel situation is a skill that takes practice and careful development. With the flood of contradictory and frequently false information that becomes more accessible by the year, developing the ability to critically evaluate presented information for its merits and flaws provides a more complete understanding of the world. This is true not only in science, but in a broad range of careers that students will pursue. I hope to be a Science Corps Fellow to help students cultivate their natural curiosity and critical thinking skills through exploration of the scientific method, hypothesis generation, and active learning activities that will push them to make connections and generate broad understanding of material.

Science Corps would also expand my skills as a teacher to include a wider range of students. By living in a new place and immersing myself in a culture different from my own, I will have the opportunity to develop teaching methods different from those I have honed in my 5+ years teaching in the USA. Teaching to a variety of student backgrounds is an aptitude necessary to have material reach as many students as possible.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I have had the opportunity to be a Teaching Fellow for 3 very different courses at Yale, as well as a supplemental instructor for introductory biology and chemistry courses at Ursinus College. In addition, I participate in outreach events for middle and high school students in the community surrounding Yale, and have also written and hosted a popular science podcast through the Yale Journal of Biology and Medicine. Together, I have teaching experience with college students from a broad range of majors (from pre-medical students, to those studying political science and art), as well as middle and high school students. These experiences afforded me the ability to adapt my teaching to work with a variety of students with different scientific backgrounds and levels of interest in the material.

In addition to my hands-on experiences, I have also taken pedagogy courses through Yale's Center for Teaching and Learning. By the time I graduate with my PhD, I will have completed the Certificate of College teaching Preparation, which includes peer teaching observations and teaching tool development, as well as a variety of teaching workshops, from the fundamentals of teaching science, to designing course materials, effective grading, and active learning.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the near and long-term future? (max. 200 words)

In the near future, I would like to continue to develop my teaching abilities, gain more practical experience in the classroom, and design courses and activities to engage students in scientific material. I would like to become a well-rounded professor, while continuing to develop courses in a way that best engages student curiosity and active learning.

In the long-term, I would like to become a tenured professor at a liberal arts college, where students are trained to think complexly about material and draw connections from a broad base of knowledge. Attaining this kind of position would also include a hands-on research component, in which I would like to train my students to ask questions and develop methods of testing those questions.

Simultaneously, I would like to enter education policy to improve educational access and equality. Historically, education has undervalued the role of critical thinking, which must be changed from both the top down and, as in Science Corps, the bottom up. These goals will work hand in hand as I aim to continue working directly with students on these skills, while also gathering evidence and support for changes that will benefit students in the long run.

Your CV/Resumé

[Gorenberg-CV-ScienceCorps.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Some other mailing list
Institutional newsletter

Please specify:

Any extra comment or message

References, teaching statement, and annotated student and peer observation teaching reviews available upon request.

Sent from Science Corps